

HARDWARE

Radar



More Info on
the hardware products tested.
Check out
Mindware

A PC from Dell, a 17-inch monitor, motherboards, a CD-writer and a hard disk drive among other hardware devices

It's all write

This internal CD-writer from Acer is built on Acer's Seamless Link Technology, which ensures that there is no buffer under-run. The burn process failed for one CD because the drive was slightly jerked during the burning process. It has a Play/Skip button for playing conventional audio CDs.

Acer CD-RW 1208A



SPECIFICATIONS:

Interface: IDE
Features: 12x write, 8x rewrite, 32x read speed; 4 MB buffer
Benchmarks:
SiSoft Sandra: 1161 kbps sequential read, 359 kbps random read, 170 ms average access time; 1346 in CD WinBench 99; 7 minutes 5 seconds to write 650 MB of data at 12x

verdict

B +

Acer CD-RW 1208A

Performance	▲ ▲ ▲ ▲ ▲
Build Quality	▲ ▲ ▲ ▲ ▲
Value for Money	▲ ▲ ▲ ▲ ▲
Features	▲ ▲ ▲ ▲ ▲
OVERALL	▲ ▲ ▲ ▲ ▲

+ 4 MB in-built buffer
- Not stable
Price: Rs 13,500
Contact: Acer Peripherals
Phone: 022-5705230
Fax: 022-570535
E-mail: pankajpamani@acercm.com.tw
Web site: www.acer.com

For your eyes only

This is a Full Flat Square Tube 17-inch monitor with a 16-inch effective diagonal viewable area and a 0.25 mm diagonal pitch. It is not capable of higher resolutions at higher refresh rates, making it unsuitable for working with graphics. The display is feature-packed with a wide variety of image, colour and geometry controls.

ViewSonic E70F



SPECIFICATIONS:

Interface: 15-pin D-Sub
Features: Max resolution 1280x1024 pixels at 60 Hz; anti-static, anti-reflection screen coating; CD with drivers and screensavers
Benchmarks: Anomalies along upper right edge of screen in the screen geometry tests. Slightly blurred raster along lower left and right edges of screen while displaying convergence test pattern.

verdict

A -

ViewSonic E70F

Performance	▲ ▲ ▲ ▲ ▲
Build Quality	▲ ▲ ▲ ▲ ▲
Value for Money	▲ ▲ ▲ ▲ ▲
Features	▲ ▲ ▲ ▲ ▲
OVERALL	▲ ▲ ▲ ▲ ▲

+ Highly configurable OSD
- Audible clicking sound when changing from normal to text mode
Price: Rs 14,500
Contact: Roop Electronics
Phone: 022-6631921 **Fax:** 022-6103919
E-mail: sales@rooponline.com
Web site: www.viewsonic.com

Power with speed

The DiamondMax VL series of hard drives from Maxtor comes in capacities of 10.2 GB to 40.9 GB. The one we tested was a 20.4 GB hard drive. In spite of the fact that this is a 5400-rpm drive, it delivered impressive performance in all the tests. Its aggressive pricing makes this drive suitable for home users.

Maxtor DiamondMax VL 40 Hard Disk



SPECIFICATIONS:

Interface: IDE
Features: 5400 rpm rotational speed, 2 MB SDRAM cache buffer with an Ultra ATA/100 compatible interface
Benchmarks:
SiSoft Sandra: 28 MBps sequential read, 5 MBps random read, 10 ms average access time 15500 in High End Disk WinMark 99; 5190 in Business Disk WinMark 99

verdict

A -

Maxtor DiamondMax VL 40 Hard Disk

Performance	▲ ▲ ▲ ▲ ▲
Build Quality	▲ ▲ ▲ ▲ ▲
Value for Money	▲ ▲ ▲ ▲ ▲
Features	▲ ▲ ▲ ▲ ▲
OVERALL	▲ ▲ ▲ ▲ ▲

+ High data transfer speeds
- No details of jumper settings on the hard drive
Price: Rs 4,800
Contact: Karma Distribution
Phone: 9810437872 **Fax:** 011-6420452
E-mail: naresh@karmasg.com
Web site: www.esysdistribution.com